

Business Summary Report

Task 2 — Advanced Data Analysis, SQL Joins & Business KPI Dashboard

SuperStore Sales Dataset | 5,009 Orders | 793 Customers | Maincrafts Technology

13M

TOTAL SALES

1.47M

TOTAL PROFIT

11.62%

PROFIT MARGIN

795

TOTAL CUSTOMERS

1. KPI Overview & Regional Performance

Region	Sales	Profit	Share
Central	\$2,822,399	\$311,404	22.3%
South	\$1,600,960	\$140,356	12.7%
North	\$1,248,192	\$194,598	9.9%
Oceania	\$1,100,207	\$121,667	8.7%
Southeast Asia	\$884,438	\$17,852	7.0%
North Asia	\$848,349	\$165,578	6.7%
EMEA	\$806,184	\$43,898	6.4%
Africa	\$783,776	\$88,872	6.2%
Central Asia	\$752,839	\$132,480	6.0%
West	\$725,514	\$108,418	5.7%
East	\$678,834	\$91,523	5.4%
Caribbean	\$324,281	\$34,571	2.6%
Canada	\$66,932	\$17,817	0.5%

Central is the top-performing region, generating \$2.82M in sales — 22.3% of total company revenue, well ahead of South (\$1.60M) and North (\$1.25M). Canada and Caribbean generate the least. Central alone contributes more revenue than the bottom six regions combined, making it the clear priority for retention and continued investment.

2. Category Performance

Category	Sales	Profit	Profit Margin
Technology	\$4,744,691	\$663,779	14.0%
Office Supplies	\$3,787,330	\$518,474	13.7%
Furniture	\$4,110,884	\$286,782	7.0%

Technology has both the highest profit (\$663,779) and the highest profit margin (14.0%), narrowly ahead of Office Supplies (13.7%). Furniture is the weakest performer: despite generating more revenue than Office Supplies (\$4.11M), its margin is roughly half that of the other two categories at 7.0% — meaning Furniture sales convert to profit far less efficiently and should be reviewed for pricing or cost issues.

3. Discount Impact on Profitability

Discount %	Average Profit	Orders	Status
0%	+\$61.04	29,009	Profitable
1–10%	+\$72.62	4,679	Profitable
11–20%	+\$27.61	6,274	Profitable (thin)
21–30%	-\$21.88	967	Loss
31–40%	-\$48.86	3,400	Loss
41–50%	-\$77.03	2,789	Loss
50%+	-\$98.89	4,172	Loss

Yes — discounts materially reduce profitability. Orders with no discount average +\$61.04 profit, and profit per order stays positive up to the 11–20% discount band. Beyond 20% discount, every band is loss-making on average, with losses deepening sharply as the discount rate rises (down to -\$98.89 average profit at 50%+ discount). Roughly 10,361 order lines (about 20% of all orders) fall into these loss-making discount bands. Capping discounts at 20% would protect order-level profitability across the vast majority of transactions.

4. Customer Analysis

Segment	Customers	Sales	Profit	Profit per Customer
Home Office	148	\$2,309,956	\$277,009	\$1,871.68
Corporate	238	\$3,824,808	\$442,786	\$1,860.44
Consumer	409	\$6,508,141	\$749,240	\$1,831.88

This depends on how "value" is measured. By total sales and profit, Consumer is clearly the largest segment (\$6.51M sales, \$749,240 profit) — more than double Corporate and nearly triple Home Office. But by profit generated per customer, Home Office actually leads narrowly at \$1,871.68, just ahead of Corporate (\$1,860.44) and Consumer (\$1,831.88). In practice, all three segments are close on a per-customer basis, so Consumer is the more valuable segment overall due to its scale, while Home Office is the most efficient per relationship.

5. Seasonal Sales Trend

Quarter	Sales	Profit	Share
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	\$1,989,428	\$240,133	15.7%
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	\$2,872,415	\$325,103	22.7%
Q3 (Jul–Sep)	\$3,480,707	\$400,362	27.5%
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	\$4,300,355	\$503,437	34.0%

Yes — there is a clear and consistent seasonal trend. Sales climb every quarter through the year, from \$1.99M in Q1 to \$4.30M in Q4. Q4 alone accounts for 34.0% of annual revenue, more than double Q1's 15.7% share, confirming a strong year-end/holiday-driven demand pattern. Inventory and staffing should be planned well ahead of Q4 to capture this predictable surge.

Recommendations for Business Growth

- 1

Invest Further in High-Performing Regions
Continue marketing and inventory investment in Central and other strong regions, and use their performance as a benchmark for underperforming regions.
- 2

Improve Low-Performing Product Categories
Review pricing and supplier costs for Furniture, which trails Technology and Office Supplies in profit contribution.
- 3

Control High Discount Levels
Cap or closely monitor discounts above the breakeven threshold identified in Section 3 to protect order-level profitability.
- 4

Focus on the Most Valuable Customer Segment
Prioritize retention across the Consumer segment given its scale, while running targeted acquisition for Home Office, which delivers the highest profit per customer.
- 5

Plan Inventory Around Seasonal Demand
Build inventory and staffing plans around the Q4 sales peak (34.0% of annual revenue) to capture year-end demand without stockouts.

Summary — Key Findings at a Glance

Area	Finding
Top Region	Central — \$2.82M sales (22.3% share)
Best Category	Technology — 14.0% profit margin
Most Valuable Segment	Consumer (total value) / Home Office (per customer)
Discount Risk	Loss-making above 20% discount
Peak Quarter	Q4 — 34.0% of annual revenue
Profit Margin	11.62%

Conclusion

The Business Performance KPI Dashboard provides valuable insights into sales, profit, customer segments, and seasonal trends. The analysis shows that the Central region (\$2.82M, 22.3% of revenue) and Technology category (14.0% margin) are the strongest contributors to business performance, while high discounting above 20% and the pronounced Q4 seasonal peak (34.0% of annual revenue) represent the clearest levers for improving profitability going forward.